Lab 1: Local Files using Lakeflow Connect

Lab Summary

In this lab, we learn how to use **Lakeflow Connect (Local Files option)** to upload local CSV files and automatically create Delta tables in Databricks.

We will:

- Upload a local CSV file
- Convert it into a managed Delta table
- Understand difference between Lakehouse Federation and Lakeflow Connect
- Verify table properties

This is a **low-code / no-code ingestion method**.

Prerequisites

- Databricks Workspace access
- Unity Catalog enabled
- Serverless compute enabled
- A local CSV file (example: `dim_products.csv`)

Steps to Complete Lab

Task 1 – Navigate to Lakeflow Connect (Local Files)

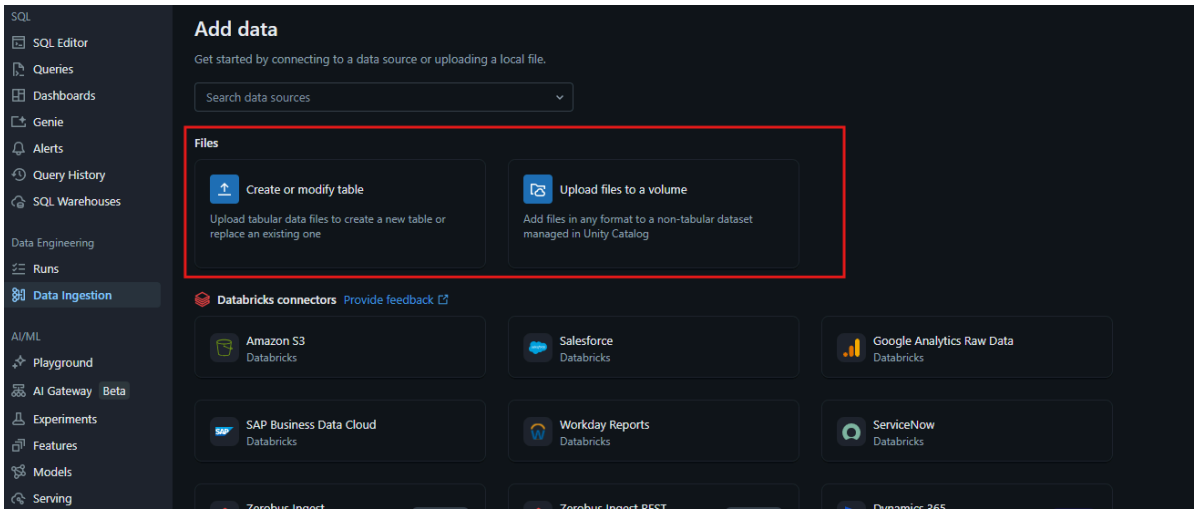
1.1 Open Data Ingestion

1. Go to **Data Engineering**

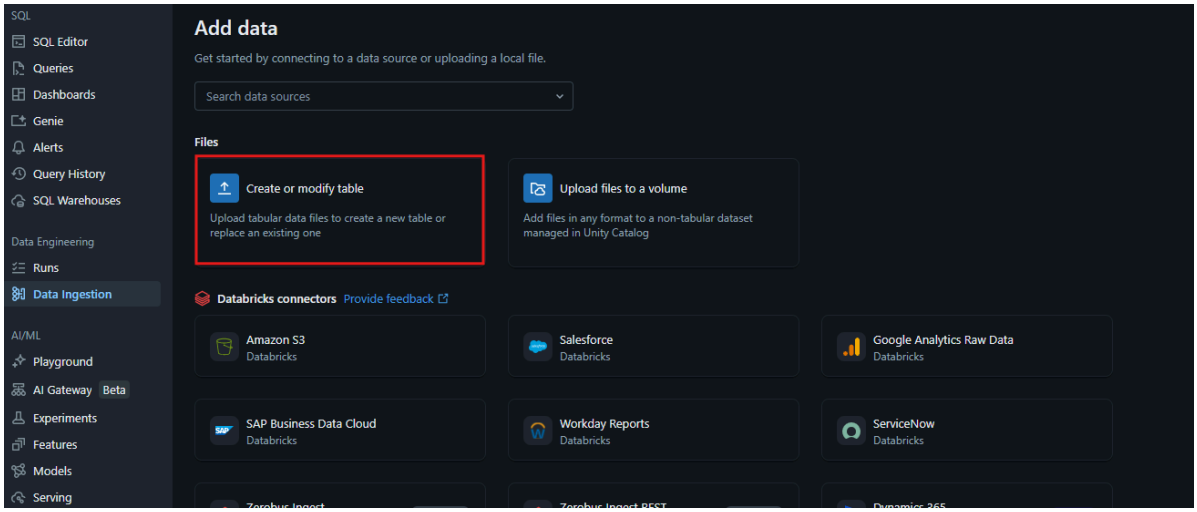
2. Click on **Data Ingestion**

1.2 Select Files Option

1. Go to **Files section**



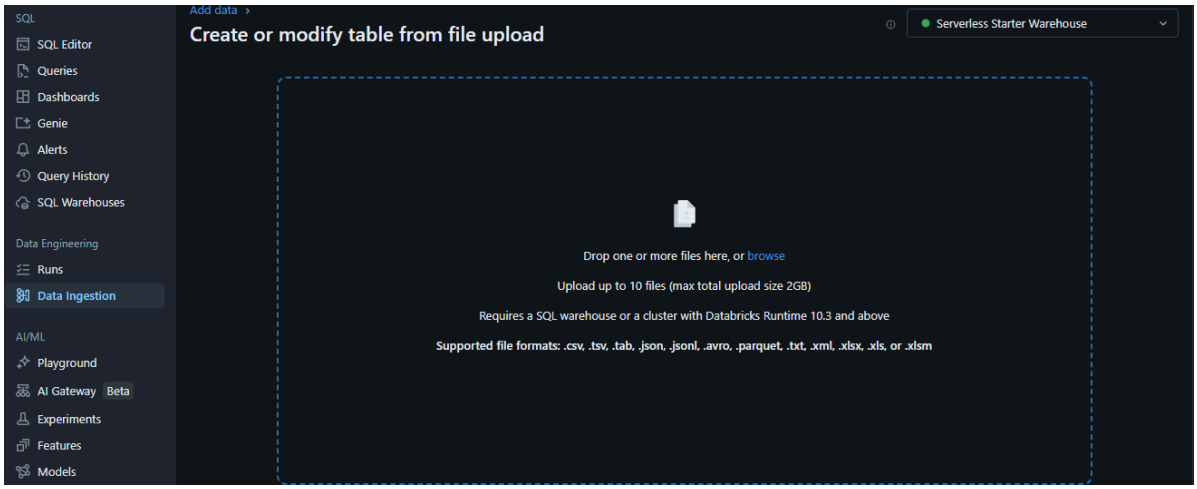
2. Click on **Create or Modify table**



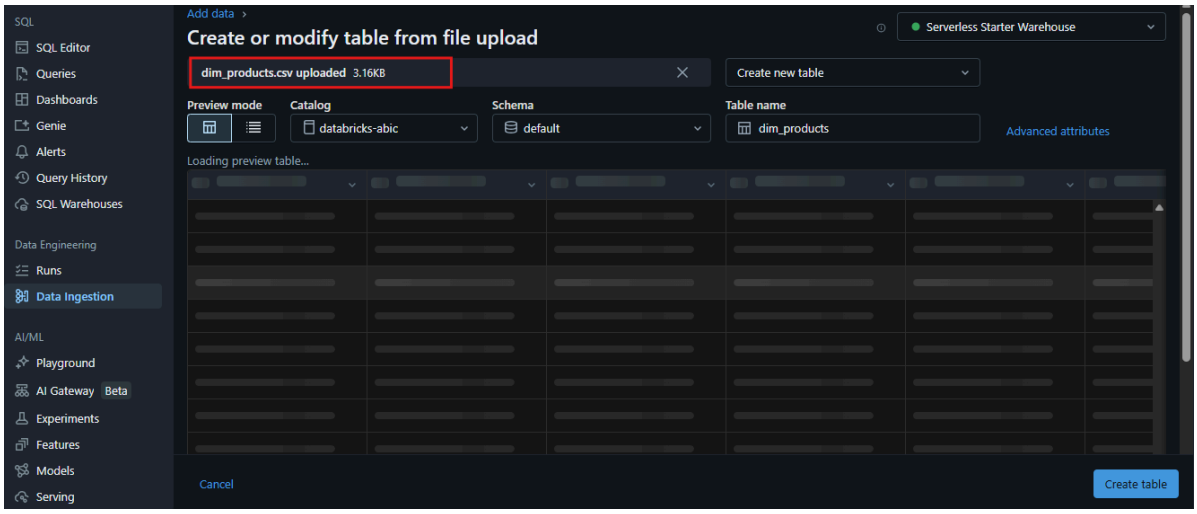
Task 2 – Upload Local CSV File

2.1 Upload File

1. Click **Upload**



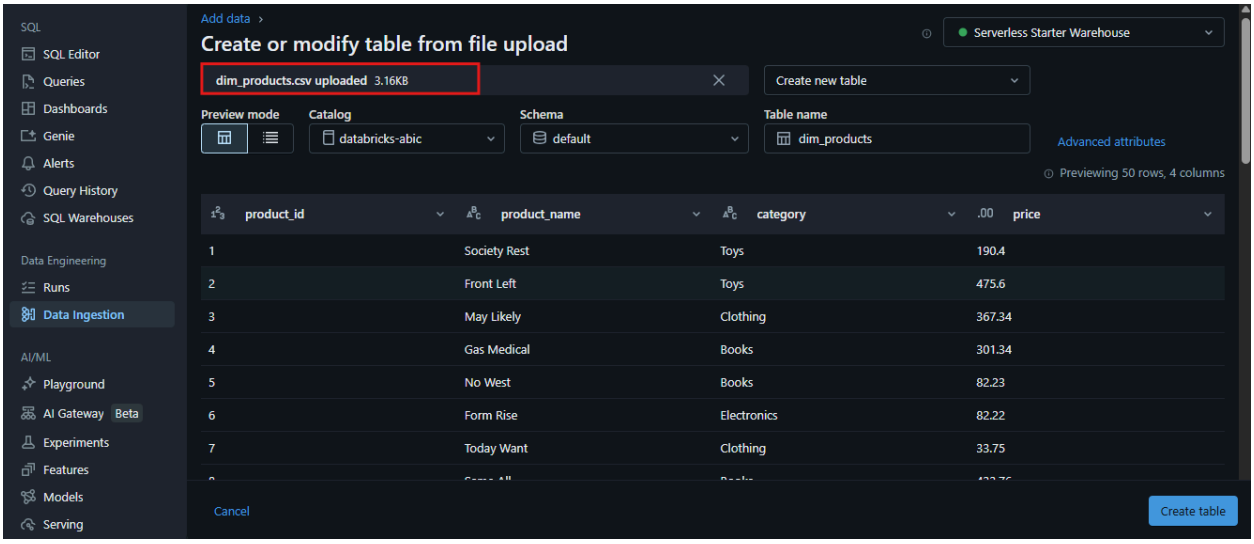
2. Select local file (example: `dim_products.csv`)



3. Databricks will:
    - Start serverless compute
    - Process the file
    - Detect schema automatically

2.2 Review Schema

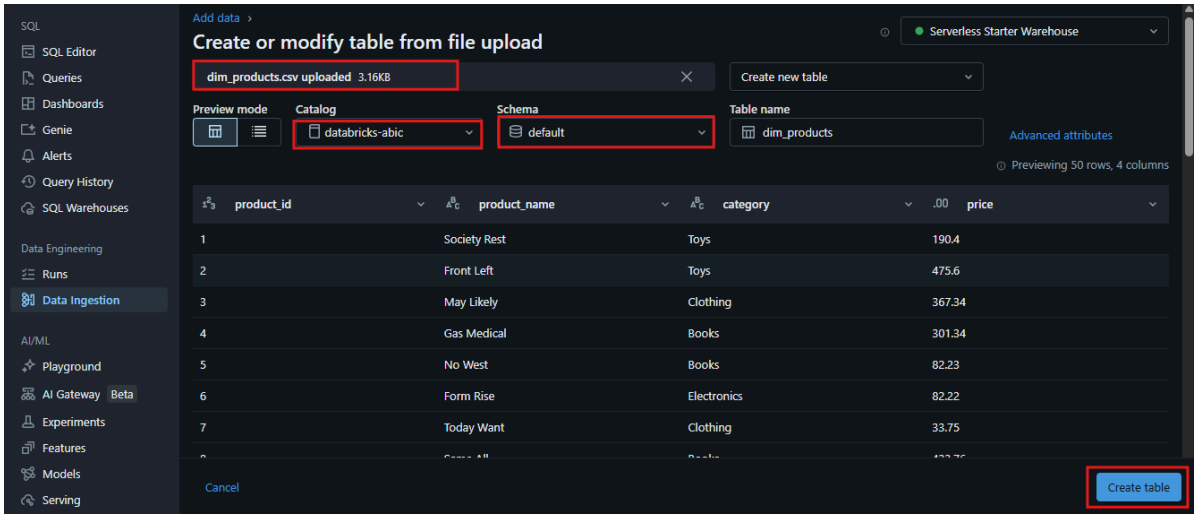
- Verify column names
- Verify data types
- Modify if required



Task 3 – Create Delta Table

3.1 Click Create Table

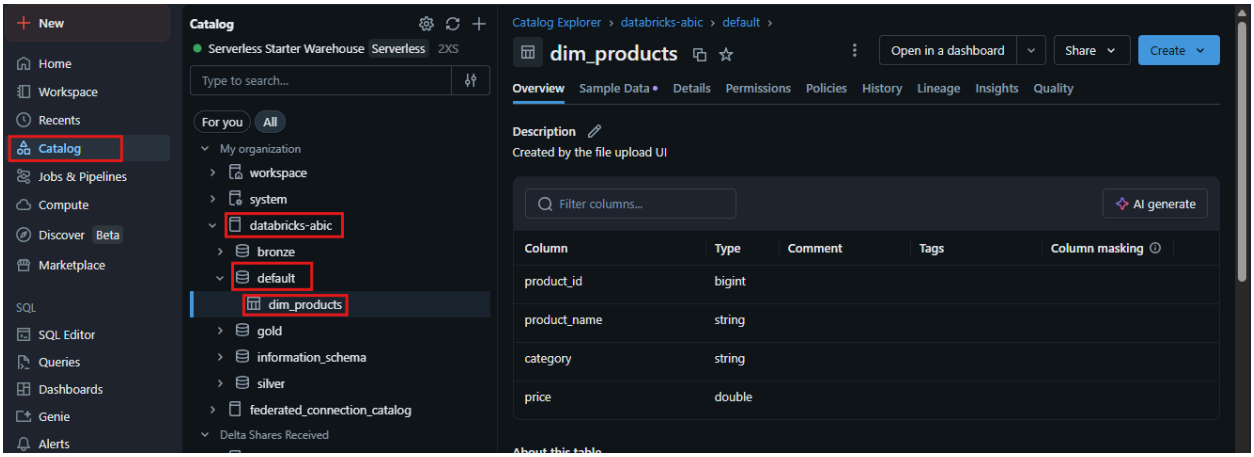
1. Click **Create Table**
2. Select:
   - Catalog → `databricks`
   - Schema → `default`
3. Click **Create**



Task 4 – Verify Table

4.1 Open Catalog

1. Go to **Catalog**
2. Select `databricks`
3. Select `default`
4. Open the newly created table

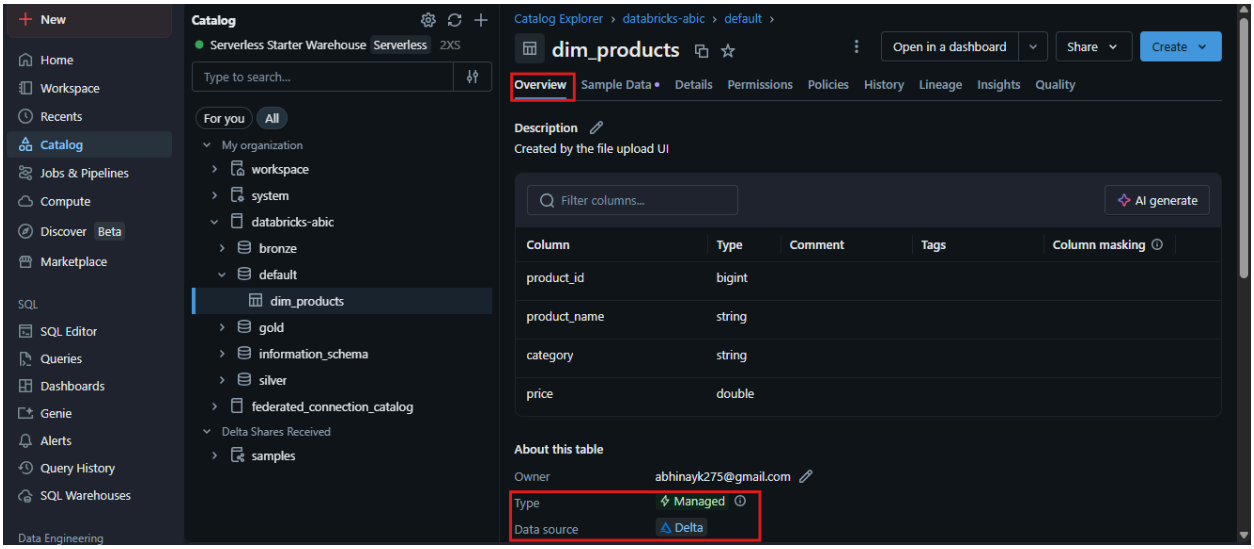


4.2 Verify Table Type

Click **Overview** tab.

You will observe:

- Table Type → **Managed**
- Format → **Delta**
- Storage → Stored in connected cloud storage (AWS)



Important Notes

- This creates **Managed Delta Tables**
- Data is stored in connected cloud account
- No manual coding required
- Ideal for quick ingestion

Outcome

After completing this lab, you can:

- Upload local CSV files
- Create managed Delta tables
- Understand Lakeflow Connect
- Differentiate Federation vs Connect
- Verify Delta table properties